

Political Challenges in Japan's government

Emperor Yoshihito -> sickly -> too weak to exercise his authority over Japan's government. Many of the Genro -> advised that emperor had also left Japan's political scene due to age. Without strong emperor or the Genro to unify the government divisions between court officials - civilian politicians and military worsened.

- Military -> opposed the internationalist policy of diplomacy and trade led by civilian politicians and resented the prime ministers and their cabinets - for cutting military's budget.
- Military -> began to act on its own.
 - They disregarded the prime ministers and cabinets and emperor Yoshihito could not enforce much control over them.

Civilian politicians in the cabinet and the diet -> were also divided -> because of the emergence of party politics.

2 political parties -> elected into the diet, Seiyukai, and Minseitō -> were political rivals which wrestled for power and influence in the government.

divisions -> between these 2 parties -> made it challenging for the PM to gain support of the majority.

-> many of the Taishō Period Prime ministers -> and their cabinets -> did not remain in power for so long.

Some cabinets -> could not be formed when military refused to supply ministers for the army and the navy.

1. The prime minister was appointed by the emperor -> with the advice of the Genro. the leader -> of the most successful political party -> in an election was not always appointed.	2. in order to get new laws passed by the diet -> PM had to gain majority support from the Diet. However -> this was challenging because diet was a coalition government -> with multiple political parties. Politicians from opposing parties -> could refuse to support the Prime ministers decisions.
3. The prime ministers had to take into account the interests of the Genro and the Privy council. -> Privy council -> advised the emperor and had enough influence to overturn decisions made by the prime minister. -> Privy council forced some prime ministers to resign.	4. another problem -> was that military leaders -> were appointed by emperor -> Not prime minister. This meant PM -> did not have authority to remove military officials who did not follow his policies.